

HCI & UX DESIGN FINAL PROJECT

AURA

The Future of Personal Styling

"Not just a shopping app, but a style assistant. A personalized fashion experience powered by artificial intelligence."

Prepared by: Yiğit Cenik

2103670

Department: Digital Game Design

Problem Definition

In today's fashion e-commerce apps (Zara, H&M, etc.), users experience "Choice Overload." They get lost among thousands of products and cannot find an answer to the question "What do I wear this with?".

Although current interfaces are visually rich, they fall short in navigation and personalization.

Our Solution: AURA

An AI-powered Super-App that learns the user's style, offers personalized outfits, and transforms the shopping process from a "task" into an "experience."



Personalization

A custom store front for every user.



AI Integration

Instant style consultancy with AI.



Speed

Purchasing with minimum clicks.



Accessibility

Inclusive design(Dark Mode, A11y).

2. The Challenge

KEY ISSUES

Before starting the design process, we analyzed the fundamental deficiencies (Pain Points) in current market standards.

1. Visual Noise & Readability

In current apps, product images overlap with text, reducing readability and causing users to lose focus.

2. Decision Fatigue

Users like a single piece but abandon the purchase because they can't combine it (Cart Abandonment).

3. Navigation Maze

Too many menus need to be opened to reach categories (Hamburger Menu syndrome).



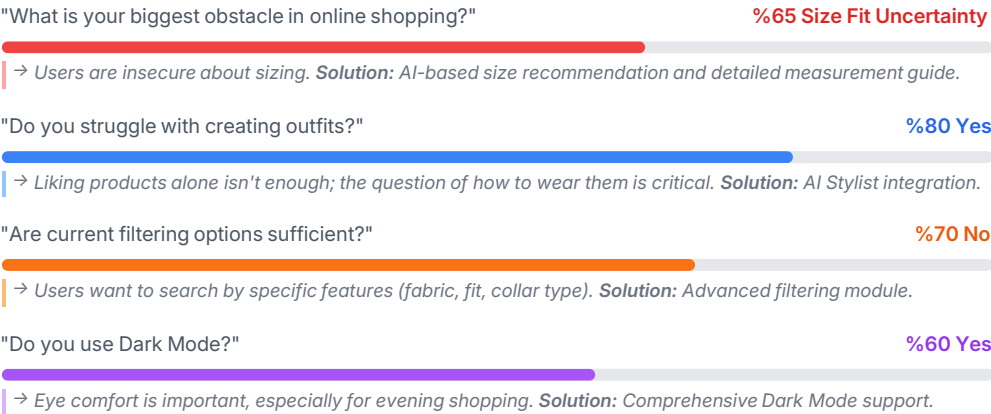
Goal

"Designing a clean and intelligent interface that offers the user the most suitable options instead of drowning them among products."

3. User Research and Insights

We based our design decisions on data obtained from comprehensive surveys with 20 participants and detailed guerrilla tests with 5 people. **Our goal was to understand not just "what" users want, but "why" they want it and "how" they behave.**

A Survey Findings (20 People)



B Guerrilla Test Observations (5 People)

Task: "Find a black linen shirt in the Zara app, select your size, and add it to the cart."

⚠

"I couldn't find the linen filter, I had to check contents one by one." (Time Loss)

⚠

"The Add to Cart button is too low, I had to scroll constantly." (Ergonomics Issue)

⚠

"Text disappeared when I zoomed into the product photo, I forgot the price." (Visual Hierarchy)

**Design Action Plan**

1. Navigation: Thumb-friendly bottom menu (Bottom Nav) instead of hamburger menu.

3. Sticky Button: Fix the "Add to Cart" button at the bottom of the screen.

2. Smart Filter: Detailed filters based on fabric, fit, and occasion (Wedding, Office, etc.).

4. Clear Info: Product price and size should always be visible (Sticky Header).

4. Competitor Analysis and Strategic Positioning

When examining dominant players in the market (Zara, ASOS), it is seen that a choice is usually made between "Editorial Visuals" and "Usability." **AURA** fills the gap between these two extremes with **AI-Powered Personalization**, positioning itself as a "Smart Fashion Assistant."

FEATURE / CRITERIA	ZARA (Current)	ASOS	AURA (Our App)
Visual Hierarchy	Complex & Cluttered	Standard Grid	Minimalist & Focused
Navigation	Hidden Menu (Hard)	Bottom Bar (Easy)	Smart Bottom Bar (Hub)
Personalization (AI)	None	"Buy this too" (Basic)	Fully Integrated Stylist
Accessibility	Poor (Small Font)	Medium	WCAG 2.1 (Dark Mode)
Checkout Process	5+ Steps	3 Steps	One Page (Frictionless)

THE MARKET GAP

While current applications focus solely on "selling products" to the user, the user's main need for "styling and decision support" is ignored.

AURA goes beyond being an e-commerce site and fills this gap by acting as a "Fashion Assistant" that understands the user's wardrobe and offers proactive suggestions.



ZARA: Aesthetics > Function

Visuals are impressive but navigation elements are invisible. The user asks "What should I do now?". **Critical Error:** Hamburger menu usage.



ASOS: Functional Clutter

Too many features and filters. The user drowns in options (Choice Overload). **Deficiency:** No personal touch.



5.1 User Analysis: Trend Hunter

PRIMARY
PERSONA



Melis (24)

SOCIAL MEDIA SPECIALIST

QUOTE
"I follow trends instantly. I can't stand waiting; I want to buy what I see immediately."

CAPACITIES

Perception
Visually oriented. Quickly scans colors and patterns.

Motor Skills
High hand-eye coordination. Fast scrolling.

Cognitive
Multitasker. Decides quickly but has a short attention span.

SKILLS & KNOWLEDGE

- Digital Native.
- Master of mobile payment systems.

FURTHER CHARACTERISTICS

Brand loyalty is low; loyal to experience.
Responds positively to gamification.

MOTIVATION

Attitudes to Job/Role Sees fashion as an expression of identity.

- User Goals**
- Finding instant outfit inspiration.
 - Catching products before stock runs out.

- Frustrations**
- Slow-loading pages.
 - Lack of outfit suggestions.

INTERACTION WITH SYSTEM

Extent of Use: High frequency (5+ times a day). Short sessions.

Level of Engagement: High interaction. Favorites products, shares them, chats with AI assistant.

Further Characteristics: Low tolerance for errors. If the app crashes or freezes, she may delete it and switch to a competitor.

5.2 User Analysis: Efficiency Seeker

DETAILED PERSONA
BREAKDOWN



Can (32)
ARCHITECT

QUOTE
"Shopping is a task. I want to get it done quickly and get back to work."

CAPACITIES

Perception
Detail-oriented. Looks for technical info (fabric content, fit). Values information hierarchy over visuals.

Motor Skills
Standard usage. Prefers clear and large buttons over precise gestures.

Cognitive
Analytical thinker. Expects a logical category structure (Men > Shirts > Slim Fit). Cognitive load increases with clutter.

SKILLS & KNOWLEDGE

- High technology literacy.
- Uses filtering tools professionally.
- Conscious about online security.

FURTHER CHARACTERISTICS

Likes minimalist interfaces. Dislikes ads and pop-ups.

MOTIVATION

Attitudes to Job/Role
Sees shopping as a necessary "logistics operation" to manage his wardrobe.

Attitudes to Tasks
Task-oriented. Wants to finish the task (purchase) in minimal steps.

- User Goals**
- Finding a specific product in 1 minute.
 - Fast payment (Guest Checkout).

- Frustrations**
- Forced membership.
 - Hidden menus.

INTERACTION WITH SYSTEM

Extent of Use: Low frequency (As needed). Goal-oriented, short sessions.

Level of Engagement: Low. Only uses functional features (Search, Filter, Cart). Does not browse in discovery mode.

Further Characteristics: Closer to desktop experience, seeks the same clarity on mobile.

5.3 User Analysis: Conscious Shopper

DETAILED PERSONA
BREAKDOWN



Ayşe (45)
TEACHER

QUOTE
"I don't buy what I can't read.
Trust and clarity are everything
to me."

CAPACITIES

- Perception**
Reduced visual acuity (Presbyopia). Struggles to perceive low-contrast text and small icons.
- Motor Skills**
Fine motor skills may be slower. Prone to errors with small touch targets.
- Cognitive**
Slower learning curve for new interfaces.
Prefers standard and familiar icons (Cart, Home).

SKILLS & KNOWLEDGE

- Basic smartphone usage.
- Sensitive about credit card security.
- Reads return policies in detail.

FURTHER CHARACTERISTICS

Afraid of making mistakes, needs undo options.

MOTIVATION

- Attitudes to Job/Role**
Conscious consumer. Prioritizes quality and comfort.
- Attitudes to Tasks**
Shops carefully and slowly. Wants to examine every detail, dislikes being rushed.
- User Goals**
 - Legible interface (Large Text).
 - Transparent pricing.
- Frustrations**
 - Small fonts.
 - Complex return buttons.

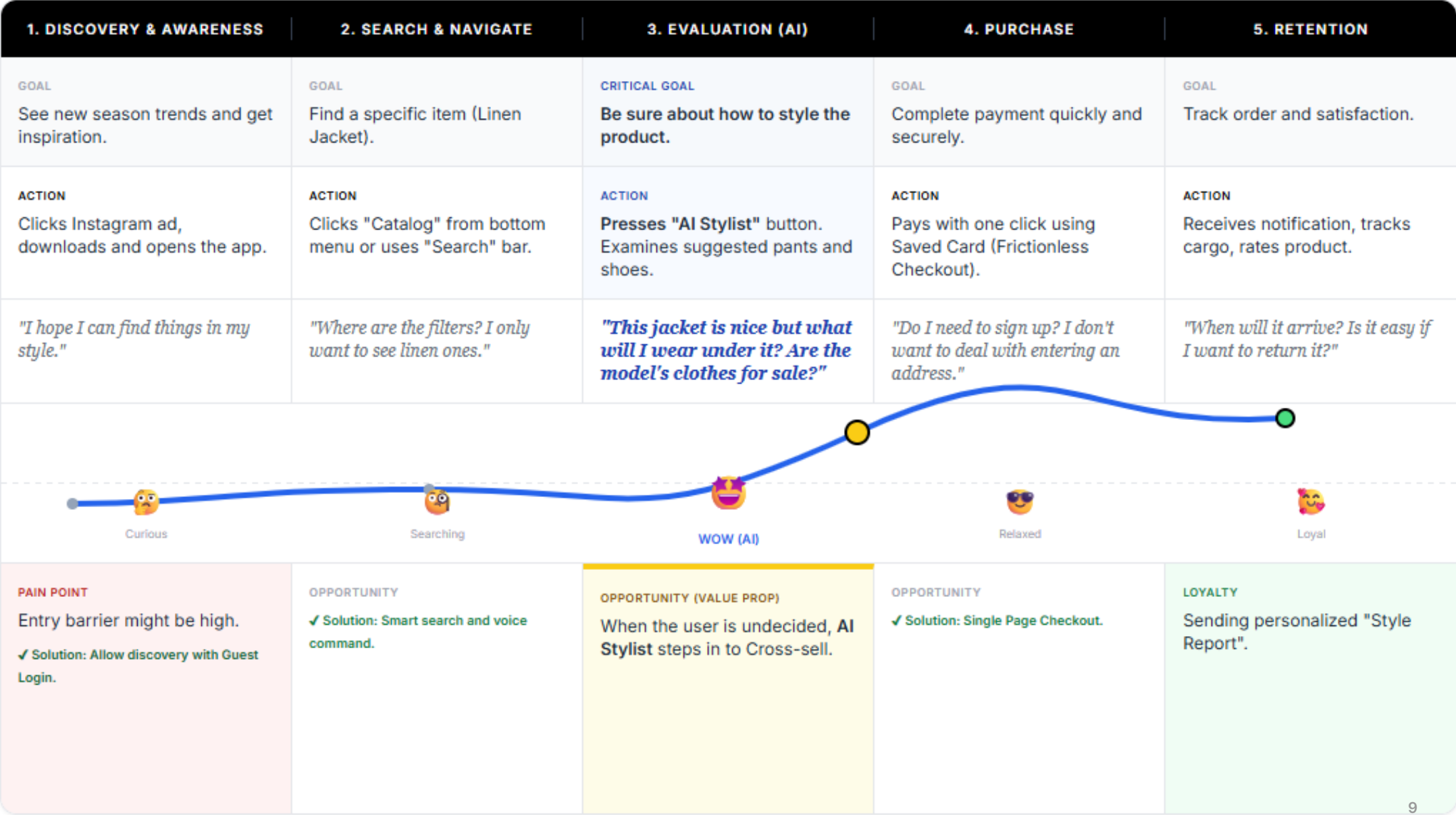
INTERACTION WITH SYSTEM

- Extent of Use:** Medium frequency. Usually uses it in the evening, comfortably at home.
- Level of Engagement:** Detailed. Reads product descriptions to the end, examines size charts.
- Further Characteristics:** The profile that needs Accessibility features (Dark Mode, Zoom) the most.

6. Customer Journey Map

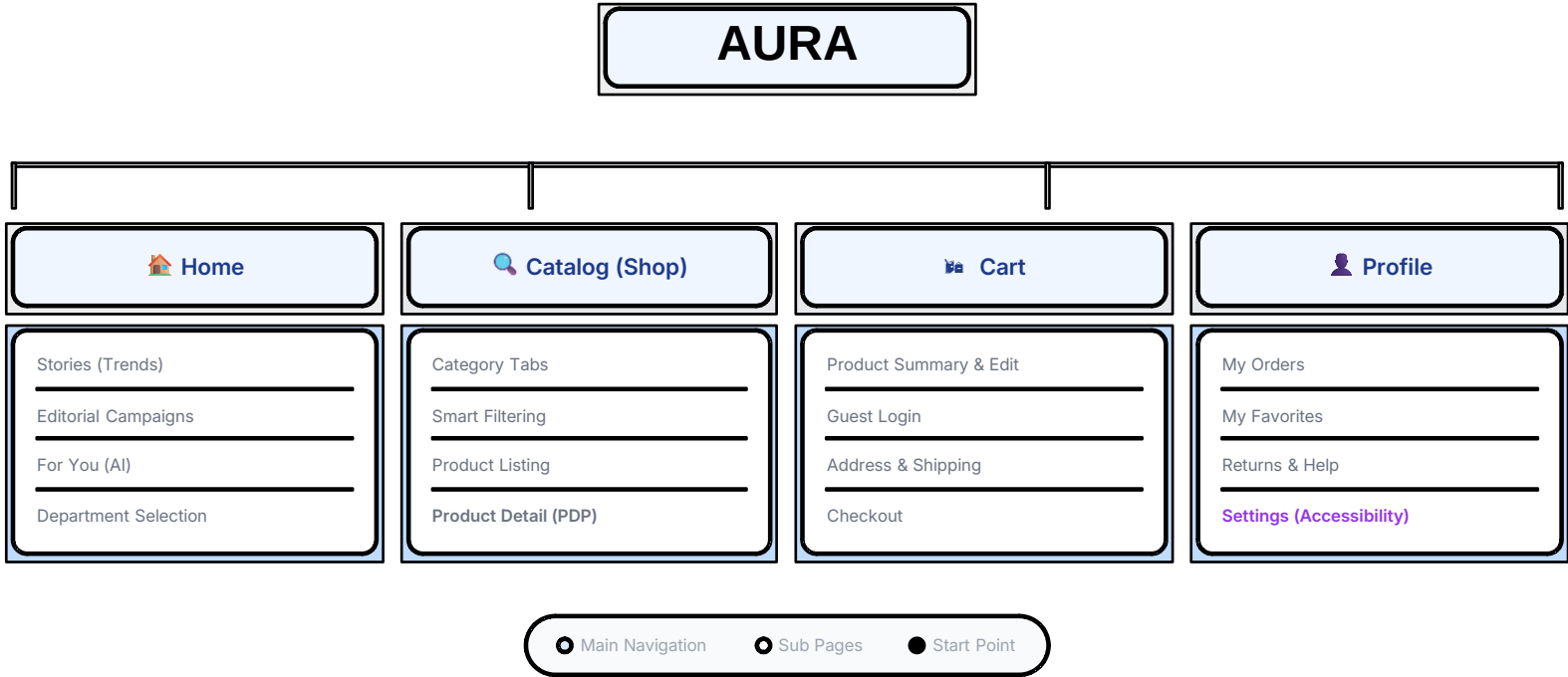
USER EXPERIENCE
LIFECYCLE

User Melis's end-to-end experience in the AURA app analyzed through Goal, Action, Thought, Feeling, and Opportunity layers. This map is directly related to our research findings (Slide 3).



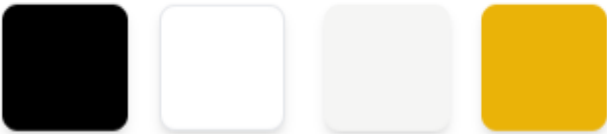
7. New Information Architecture (Site Map)

The structure of the AURA app is based on the principle of reaching the goal with minimal clicks. Instead of a complex "Hamburger Menu," all main functions are accessible via the **Tab Bar**.



8. Design System

Color Palette



Primary Background Surface Accent (AI)

Typography

Playfair Display

Headings

Inter

UI Elements

Iconography & Buttons

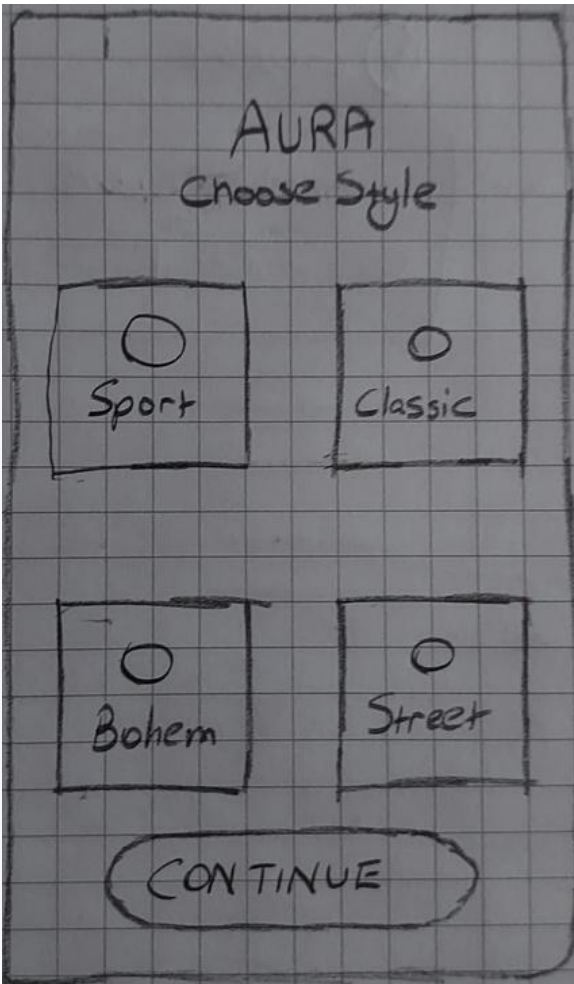


9. Wireframe: Smart Onboarding

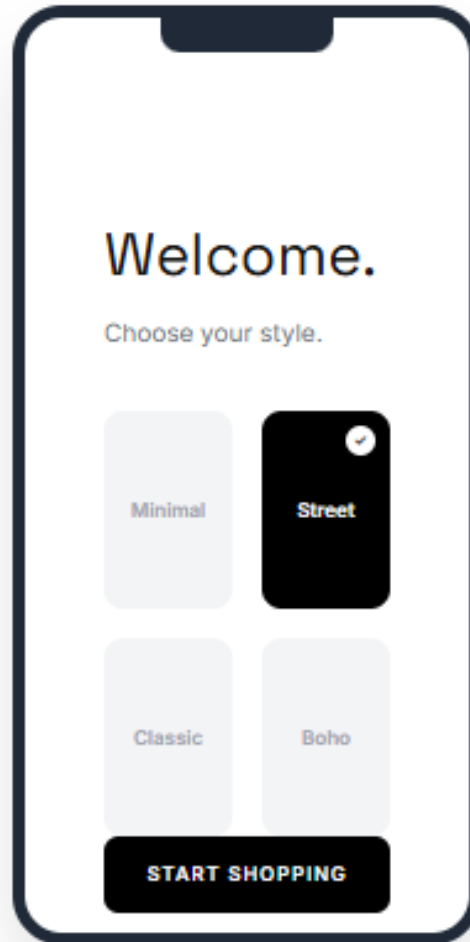
Wireframe: Replaced generic login with immediate **style selection buttons** (Sport, Classic) to capture user preferences early.

Final UI: Gamified the experience with **high-quality visuals** and a personalized welcome. This initial step now directly feeds the **"For You" algorithm**.

1. PAPER SKETCH



2. DIGITAL WIREFRAME

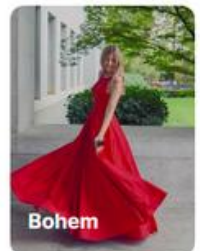


CONTEXT
INJECTION

3. MOCKUP

Hoşgeldin.

Sana özel bir deneyim için tarzını seç.



ALİŞVERİŞE BAŞLA →

10. Wireframe: Home Screen

ENTRY
POINT

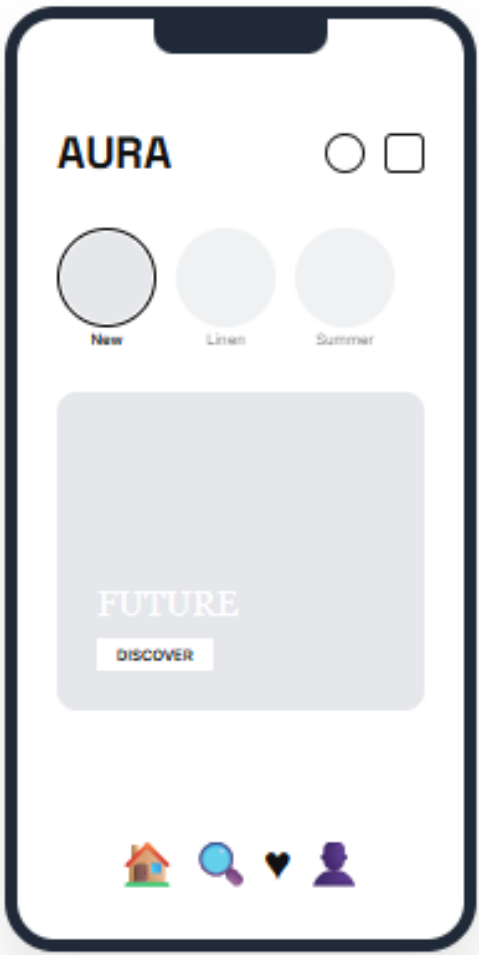
Wireframe: Focuses on trends with a large hero image and scrollable bubbles.

Mockup: Added a **Bottom Dock** to move key actions into the **Thumb Zone** for better accessibility.

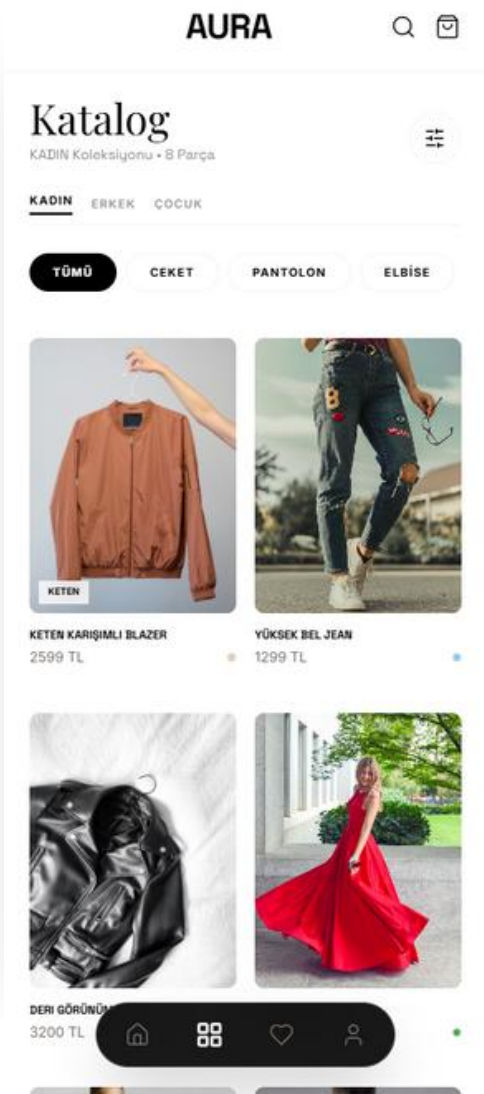
1. PAPER SKETCH



2. DIGITAL WIREFRAME



3. MOCKUP



11. Wireframe: Catalog (Shop)

Wireframe: Top tabs allow quick switching between Women/Men/Kids departments.

Final UI: Converted categories into a **horizontal scroll bar** and simplified product cards for maximum readability.

NAVIGATION &
FILTER

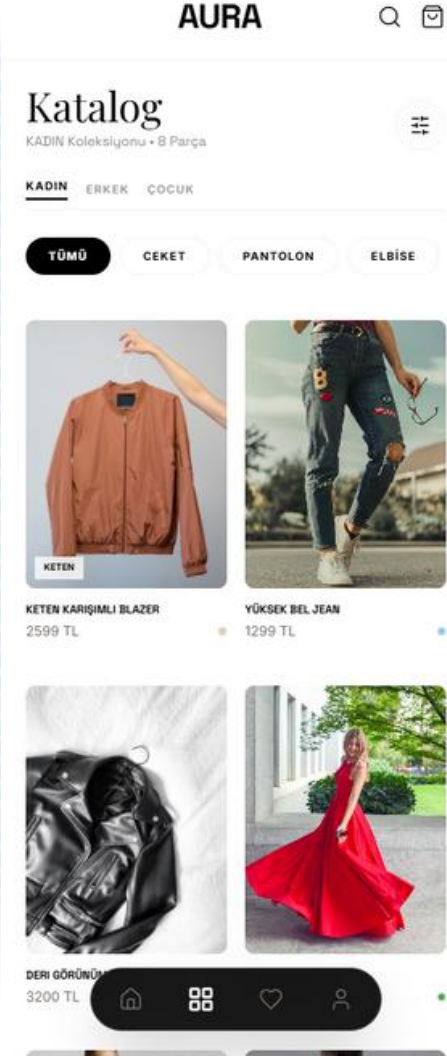
1. PAPER SKETCH



2. DIGITAL WIREFRAME



3. MOCKUP

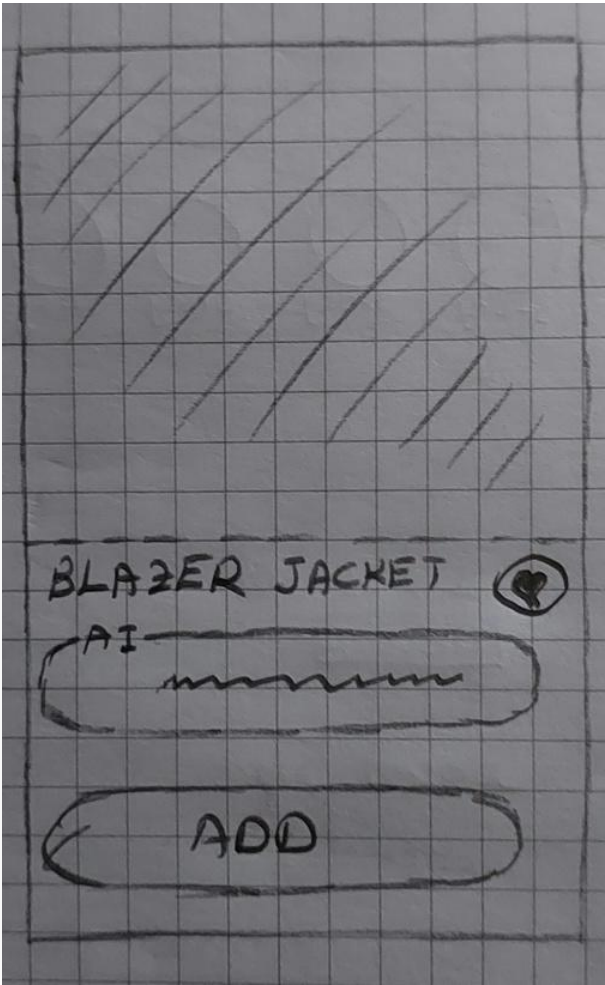


12. Wireframe: Product Detail

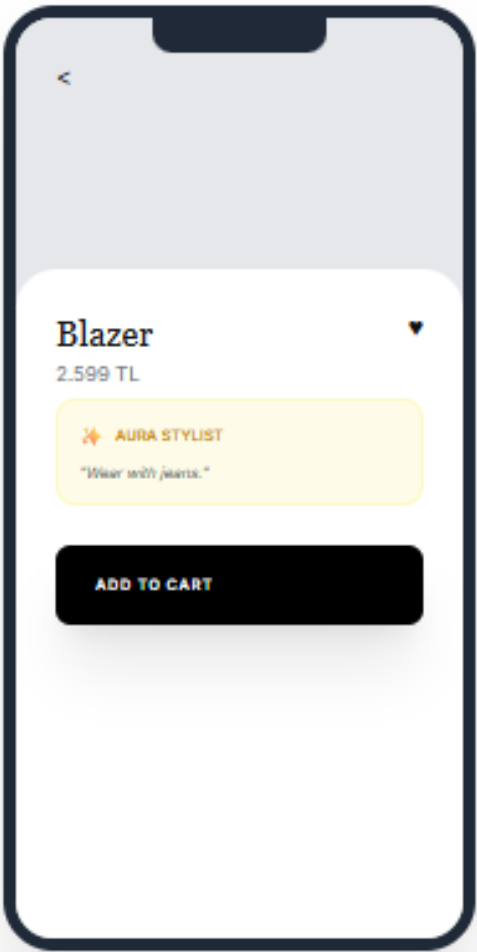
Wireframe: Includes an "AI Suggestion" box to help users style the item.

Final UI: "Add to Cart" is now a **Sticky Button** at the bottom for a seamless shopping experience.

1. PAPER SKETCH



2. DIGITAL WIREFRAME



3. MOCKUP



Müşteri Yorumları

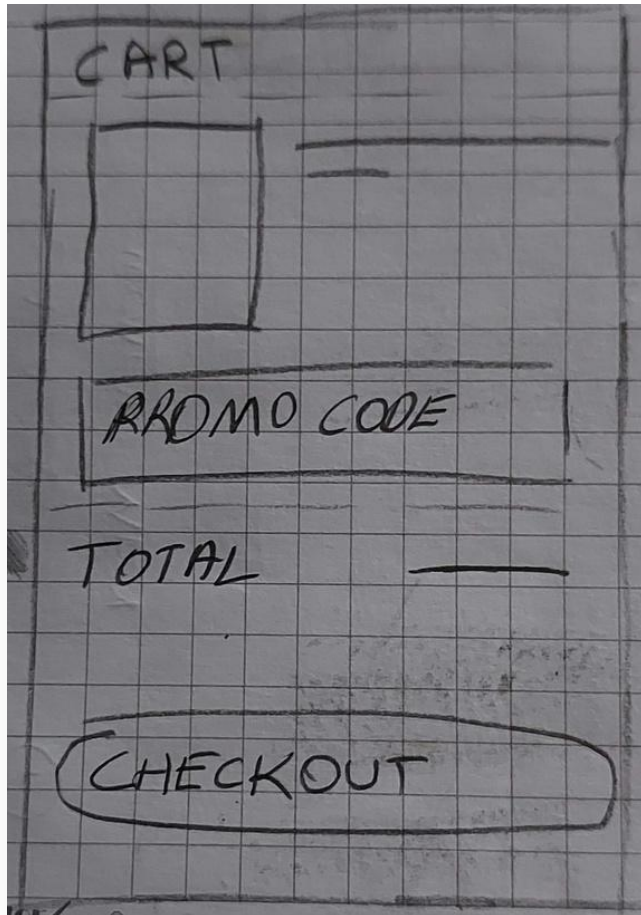
13. Wireframe: Cart & Checkout

Wireframe: A single-page flow combining address and payment info.

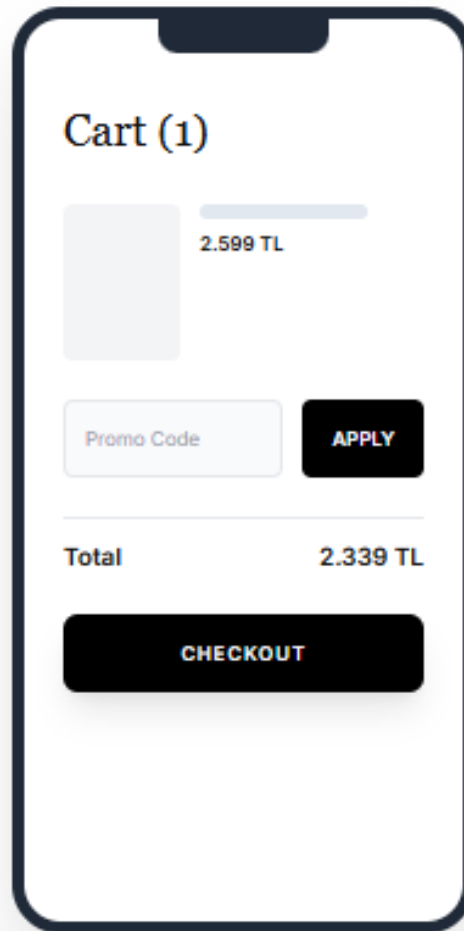
Final UI: Frictionless Checkout: Steps (Cart > Address > Pay) happen in a **Bottom Sheet** without leaving the screen.

FINAL
STEPS

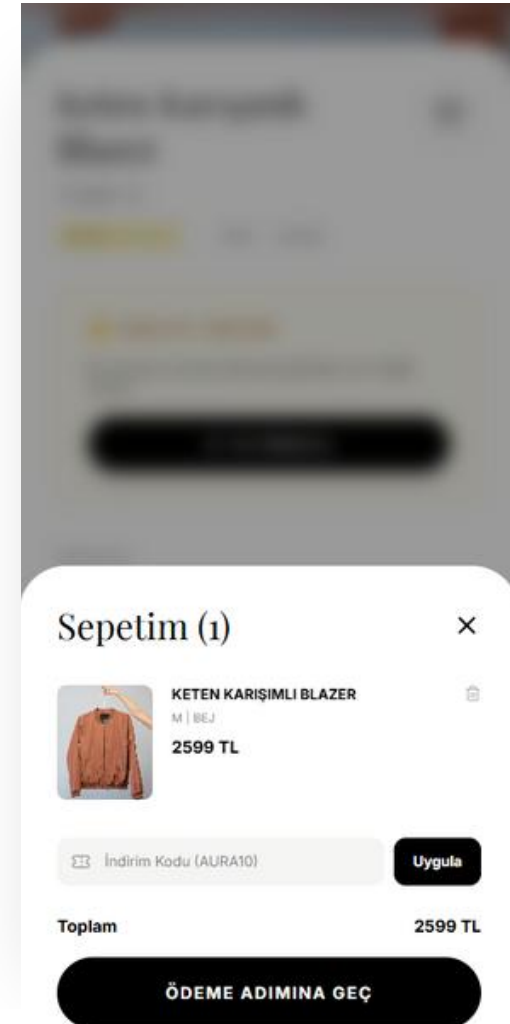
1. PAPER SKETCH



2. DIGITAL WIREFRAME



3. MOCKUP



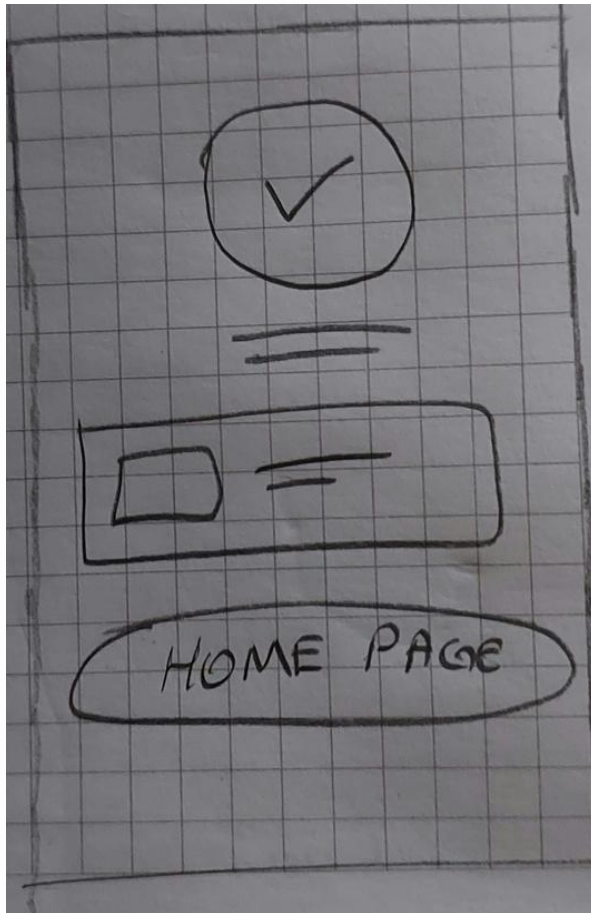
14. Wireframe: Order Success

Wireframe: A simple confirmation screen with a "Thank You" message and a "Return to Home" button.

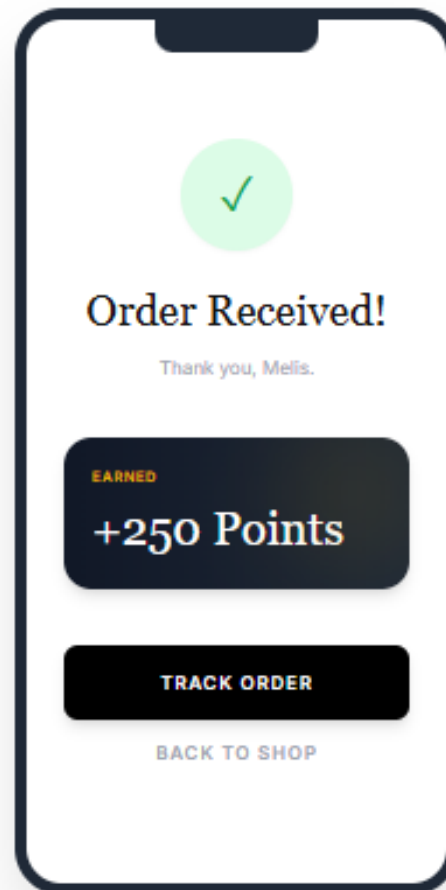
Final UI: Applied the **Peak-End Rule** with a vibrant success visual. Added **Loyalty Points** for retention and a **"Track Order"** button to boost user confidence.

RETENTION &
FEEDBACK

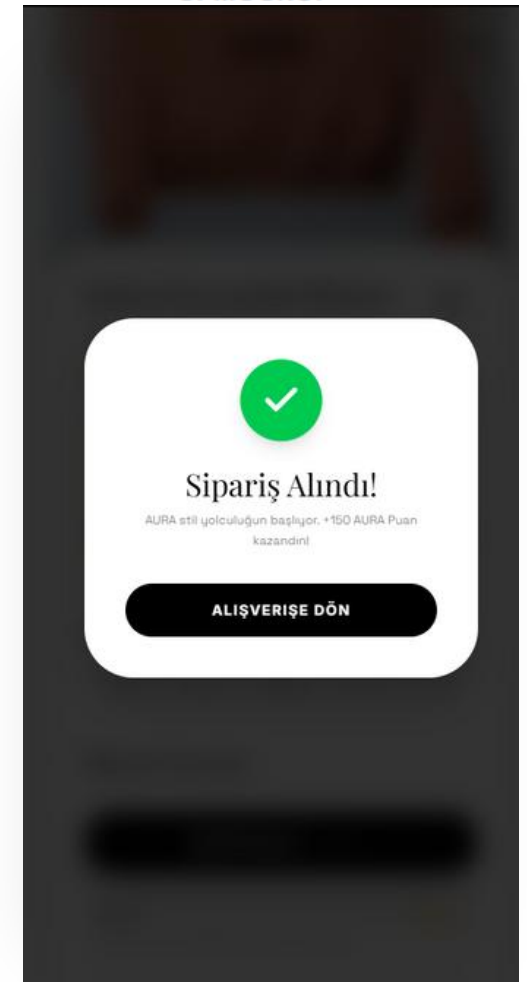
1. PAPER SKETCH



2. DIGITAL WIREFRAME



3. MOCKUP



15. Wireframe: Profile & Settings

Wireframe: Classic side drawer for essential category navigation.

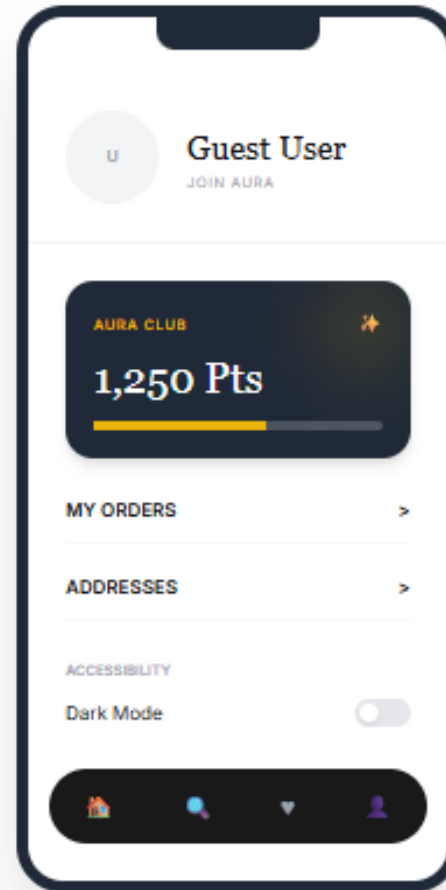
Final UI: Uses a **Dark Overlay** to minimize distractions and focus the user on navigation.

USER
ACCOUNT

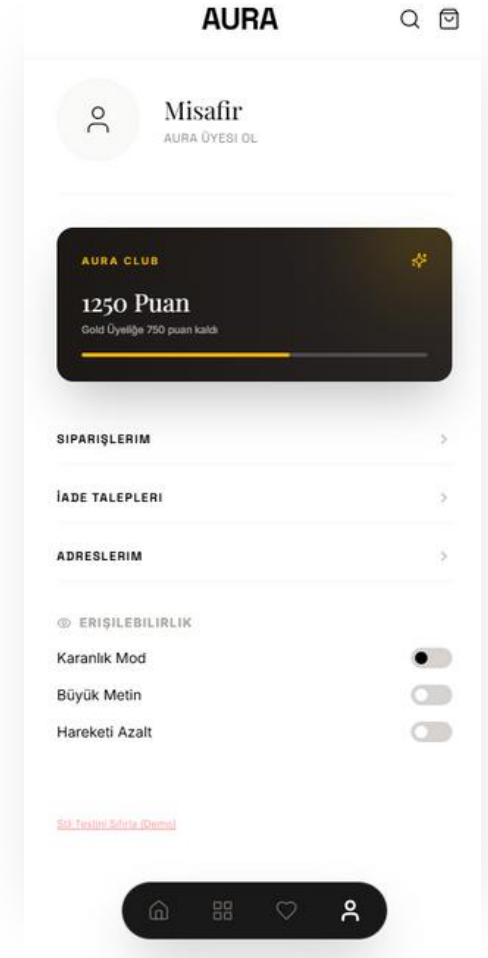
1. PAPER SKETCH



2. DIGITAL WIREFRAME



3. MOCKUP



16. Final Solution: AI Stylist

INNOVATION

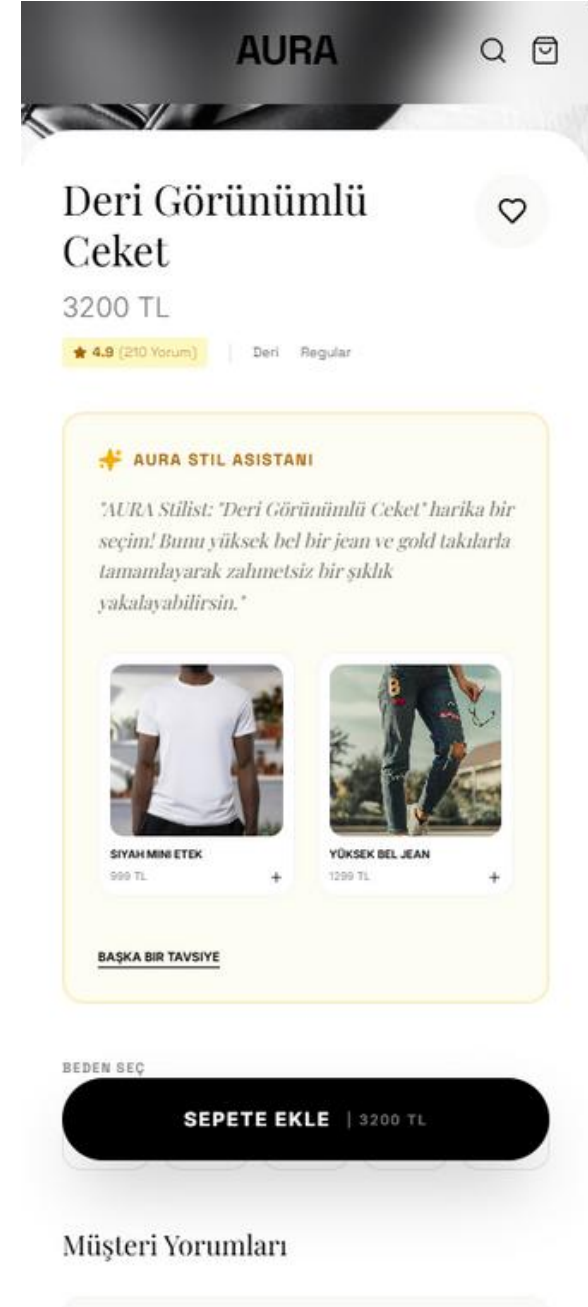
Why AI Touch

1. Eliminating Decision Fatigue: Accelerates the purchasing process by solving the users' biggest barrier: the struggle to create outfits.

2. Personalized Experience: Powered by the Google Gemini API, the algorithm delivers dynamic, product-specific style suggestions that make the user feel truly special.

3. Increasing Basket Value: Naturally drives cross-selling by presenting complementary items (accessories, shoes) that match the main product at the exact right moment.

User Scenario: "Melis likes a linen jacket but doesn't know how to style it. With a single click, the AI Stylist completes the look by suggesting 'beige trousers and leather sandals,' and Melis adds them to her cart without hesitation."



17. Accessibility and Inclusivity

ACCESSIBILITY
(A11Y)



Dark Mode

Fully compatible dark theme for eye comfort in low light.



Large Text

Dynamic text scaling for those with visual impairments.



Reduce Motion

Disable animations for those with motion sensitivity.

Conclusion and Value

With the AURA project, the traditional e-commerce experience has been transformed into a **personalized, intelligent, and accessible** structure.

 **Live Prototype:** <https://v0-aurafinalproject.vercel.app>